

文 法 Grammar

1 ～たい

You can use a verb stem (the verb form that goes before ます)+たいです to describe your hope or aspiration.

今度の週末は、映画を見たいです。 or 映画が見たいです。

I want to see a film this weekend.

いつか中国に行きたいです。

I want to go to China someday.

verb stem + たいです *I want to do . . .*

As you can see in the first example above, a verb that usually takes the particle を can have either the particle を or が when it is followed by たい. Particles other than を remain the same, as in the second example, which has に.

たい conjugates as an い-adjective. Here are examples of negative and past tense たい sentences.

あの人には会いたくないです。

I don't want to see that person.

お弁当が買いたかったから、コンビニに行きました。

I went to a convenience store, because I wanted to buy a boxed lunch.

If your wish is one you have entertained for some time, that is, if you “have wanted to,” you can use たいと思っています instead of たいです.

留学したいと思っています。

I've wanted to study abroad.

You usually do not use たいです to describe wishes held by others. Somebody else's wishes are usually reported in Japanese either as quotations, observations, or guesses. So if you want to say that somebody other than you wants to do something, you can use と言っていました with たい.

メアリーさんはチベットに行きたいと言っていました。

Mary said she wanted to go to Tibet.

To describe your observation to the effect that somebody wants to do something, you must use a special verb たがっている instead of たい. If a verb takes the particle を, the derived verb たがっている will retain を, unlike たい, with which we had a choice between the particles が and を.

メアリーさんは着物を着たがっています。

(It seems) Mary wants to wear a kimono.

The verb たがっている, which comes from the dictionary form たがる, indicates “I think that she wants to, because of the way she is behaving.” We will have more to say about this type of sentence in Lesson 14.

I want to . . . /Do you want to . . . ?

- verb stem + たいです
- たい conjugates as an い-adjective
- が or を for the direct object

They want to . . .

- verb stem + たがっています
- たがる conjugates as an う-verb
- を only

2 ～たり～たりする

You already know that you can connect two clauses with the *te*-form of predicates, as in:

大阪で買い物をして、晩ご飯を食べます。

In Osaka, I will do some shopping and eat dinner.

This sentence, however, tends to suggest that shopping and dining are *the only* activities you plan to perform in Osaka and that those two activities will be done in that order. If you want to avoid such implications and want to mention activities or events just *as examples*, and *in no set order*, you can use a special predicate form ～たり～たりする.

大阪で買い物をしたり、晩ご飯を食べたりします。

In Osaka, I will do such things as shopping and eating dinner.

verb (short, past) + り、verb (short, past) + り
do such things as this and that

To get the たり form of a predicate (したり and 食べたり in the example above), you just add り to the past tense short form of a predicate (した and 食べた). The helping verb する at the end of the sentence indicates the tense of the sentence. You can change a ～たり～たりする sentence into the past tense, or incorporate it in a bigger sentence, by working on the helping verb part.

週末は、勉強したり、友だちと話したりしました。

I studied and talked with my friends, among other things, over the weekend.

踊ったり、音楽を聞いたりするのが好きです。

I like dancing, listening to music, and so forth.

3 ～ことがある

The past tense short form of a verb + ことがある describes that you did something, or something happened, in earlier times.

富士山に登ったことがあります。

I have had the experience of climbing Mt. Fuji.

たけしさんは授業を休んだことはありません。

Takeshi has never been absent from classes (in his life).



verb (short, past, affirmative) + ことがある

have the experience of...

If somebody asks you a question using ことがありますか, you can just say あります/ありません or repeat the whole verbal complex (行ったことがあります/行ったことはありません), but not ことがあります without a verb.

A: ヨーロッパに行ったことがありますか。

Have you ever been to Europe?

B: はい、行ったことがあります。

はい、あります。

(× はい、ことがあります。)

*Yes, I have.*¹

4 Noun A や Noun B

や connects two nouns, as does と. や suggests that the things referred to are proposed as examples, and that you are not citing an exhaustive list in much the same way that たり in Grammar 2 in p. 259 suggests that the two verbs are used as examples.

A や B A and B, for example

京都や奈良に行きました。

I went to Kyoto and Nara (for example, and may have visited other places as well).

¹ We learned in Lesson 9 another way to describe past experiences or lack thereof: もう～ました and まだ～ていません. Use まだ～ていません when you have not done something but expect to do it someday. In contrast, when you say ～たことはありません, you do not think that you will eventually do it. So, unless you are an adventurer, it is funny to say まだ南極に行っていません (I haven't been to Antarctica yet) but it is perfectly normal to say 南極に行ったことはありません. On the affirmative side, もう食べました means that the result of the eating that took place is still felt now, probably that is why you are not hungry right now. 食べたことがあります means that you have had that experience, and the eating event may have taken place years ago.

表現ノート

ひょうげん

は in negative sentences ▶ In negative sentences, you often find the particle は where you expect が or を. Observe the reply sentences in the dialogues below:

Q : 山下先生はテレビを見ますか。 *Do you watch TV, Prof. Yamashita?*
やましたせんせい み

A : いいえ、テレビは見ません。 *No, I don't.*
み

Q : コーヒーが好きですか。 *Do you like coffee?*
す

A : いいえ、コーヒーは好きじゃないです。 *No, I don't.*
す

を and が, respectively, would not be ungrammatical in the above examples. Many Japanese speakers, however, find the は versions more natural.

The rule of thumb is that negative Japanese sentences tend to contain at least one は phrase. If you add 私 わたし は to the sentences above, therefore, the need for は is already fulfilled, and Japanese speakers feel much less compelled to use は after テレビ and コーヒー.

は may also follow particles like で and に.

英語では話したくないです。 *I don't want to speak in English.*
えいご はな

広島には行ったことがありません。 *I have never been to Hiroshima.*
ひろしま い

だけ ▶ You can add だけ to numbers to talk about having just that many items. だけ implies that you have something up to the amount needed, but not more than that.

私はその人に一回だけ会ったことがあります。 *I have met that person just once.*
わたし ひと いっかい あ

一つだけ質問があります。 *I have just one question.*
ひと しつもん

三十分だけ寝ました。 *I slept for just thirty minutes.*
さんじゅうふん ね

だけ suggests that you can live with that few, though the number admittedly could have been higher. We will learn another word in Lesson 14, namely, しか, which means “only” in the sense that you do not have enough of.

に ▶ You can use the particle に to indicate the occasion on which you do something.

晩ご飯にサラダを食べました。 *I ate salad at dinner.*
ばん はん た

Expression Notes

に can also indicate the role you want something to play.

おみやげに絵葉書を買いました。 *I bought a postcard as a souvenir.*
え は が き か

ドライブ ▶ ドライブ is used when you go somewhere by car for pleasure. To say “to have a drive” or “to go for a drive,” use ドライブに行く or ドライブする.

湖までドライブに行きました／ドライブしました。
みずうみ い
I went for a drive to the lake.

When you simply want to say “to drive a car” (not necessarily for pleasure), use 運転する instead.

日本で車を運転したことがありますか。
に はん くろま うんでん
Have you ever driven a car in Japan?

夢 ▶ 夢, like the English word “dream,” has two meanings. One is the dream you have while sleeping; the others the dream that you wish would come true. To say “I have a dream,” in Japanese, you use the verb 見る for sleeping dreams, and 持っている or ある for your visions.

ゆうべこわい夢を見ました。 *I had a scary dream last night.*
ゆめ み
夢を持っています／夢があります。 *I have a dream.*
ゆめ も ゆめ
あなたの将来の夢は何ですか。 *What is your future dream?*
しやうらい ゆめ なん

には ▶ The particle は often follows the particle に in sentences describing a place in terms of the things that are found there.

- (1) 東京にはデパートがたくさんあります。
とうきょう
 - (2) 東京にデパートがたくさんあります。
とうきょう
- There are many department stores in Tokyo.*

There is a subtle difference between the two sentences. The first sentence is about the places: they answer questions (either explicitly asked, or implicitly) like “What is Tokyo like?” The second sentence, on the other hand, is an answer to a question like “Where do you find many department stores?”

See the grammar note discussing the difference between が and は in Lesson 8. In the case of the particle に, the contrast is between the simple に and the combination には. (See also the grammar note on counting people in Lesson 7.)